This Hungarian soup is meant to taste fresh rather than sweet. The ratio of lemon to sugar is a guideline only, depending on how ripe the cherries are.

cherry soup

SERVES 4 **PREP TIME** 5 MINS **COOK** 15 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 6 MONTHS

CHILLED

10oz (300g) cherries, fresh or canned
2 cups white wine
1 cup water
scant 2oz (55g) sugar
1 lemon, zest and juice
1¼ cups sour cream

1 Pit the cherries and reserve the fruit. Add the pits, stems, and any juice to the wine and water in a saucepan over medium heat. Bring to a boil. Simmer, uncovered, for 10 minutes.

2 Strain the liquid into a clean pan and add the reserved fruit, sugar, and lemon. Bring to a boil then, away from direct heat, whisk in the sour cream. Chill well before serving.

CHERRIES
Look for reddish-purple, sweet cherries that are firm but give a little when squeezed. If they are underripe, store them in a fruit bowl to allow them to ripen. When ripe, they can be stored in the refrigerator for a few days.

